This step of developing the platform depends on the specifics of your business case and the nature of the data environment. If the derivation of business value requires modifying the existing platform or building a new one, now is a good time to undertake this task. We describe platform development in detail in chapter 7 and compare implementation options in chapter 8.

Keep in mind that throughout the whole data mesh development cycle, the platform in a data mesh should be treated as a product that can enable two things:

- Connecting data products and data consumers (in any required configuration)
- Automating the implementation of governance policies

Before the round of data product development and feedback collection, it is next to impossible to decide on the required scope of work on the platform. The platform development team will be properly equipped to plan its work for the next development cycle with the feedback that both data consumers and product development teams collected and analyzed.

In this chapter, you learned about the business context of a data mesh and the groundwork required for a successful kickoff of a transformation project. The next chapter will show how you can prove the assumptions related to a data mesh business value with a quick MVP.

Summary

- A data mesh is not a business goal. What is your company's strategy? If it emphasizes deriving value from data, a data mesh may be useful.
- Identify your business case with complex data needs. Next, consider whether a data mesh would help solve otherwise persistent problems, and then work from there. Remember that a data mesh is not suitable for every context.